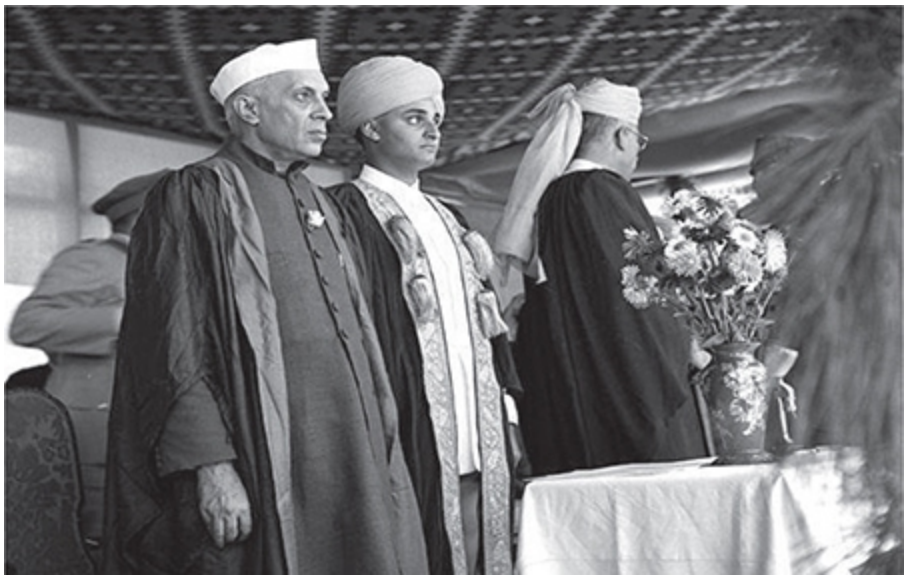


Image 7.1: Pandit Nehru with Yuvaraja Karan Singh, 1949
Source: Wikimedia Commons

Meanwhile, there were other developments taking shape overseas, which would have a strong bearing on matters in the state. Rakesh Ankit, in his cited thesis, reveals that the Soviet news agency, TASS, in a report dated 6 July 1949 openly warned the world about Anglo-American aggression against the USSR through Gilgit. The report also highlighted the suppression of communists in Pakistan and spoke at length about the anti-feudal Abdullah and his petty-bourgeoisie overlord in New Delhi, Prime Minister Nehru.[6] By February 1949, two dossiers were prepared on Abdullah and his associates on the basis of the British Residents' reports from 1942 to 1947 and a *Trud* (a Russian newspaper) article dated 29 September 1949.[7] These were added to a memorandum the newly appointed ISI Chief, Maj. Gen. Cawthorn, had prepared in January. In this, he had claimed the presence of 2,300 communists in Kashmir. Further, reports from the MI5 security liaison officer in New Delhi estimated that there were at least 100,000 communists in India, of which 1,500 were in prison. Over June and July 1949, the fear of a red fog over Kashmir deepened when Liaquat Ali Khan accepted an invitation to visit Moscow.[8]This left senior British civil and military officials serving in Pakistan and even Attlee[9]